EXP – 4 FAMILIAR AND UNFAMILIAR NAVIGATION ELEMENTS

Aim:

To design two mobile application prototypes with familiar and unfamiliar navigation elements and evaluate their usability with different user groups.

Objective:

- To understand familiar and unfamiliar navigation.
- To compare ease of use between both designs.
- To analyze user performance and satisfaction.

Description of Prototype:

App Name: Smart Queue

The application allows users to:

- Book a token
- View queue status
- Check waiting time
- Access profile

Two versions were created:

Version A – Familiar Navigation
Version B – Unfamiliar Navigation

Familiar Navigation Elements Used:

- Bottom navigation bar
- Visible back button
- Clearly labeled buttons
- Standard screen transitions

These are commonly used and easy to understand.

Unfamiliar Navigation Elements Used:

- Gesture-based navigation
- Hidden menu options
- Icons without labels
- Swipe actions instead of buttons

These are not immediately obvious to users.

Procedure:

1. Created Smart Queue prototype in Proto.io.
2. Designed 5 screens (Splash, Home, Book Token, My Token, Profile).
3. Developed Version A with familiar navigation.
4. Developed Version B with unfamiliar navigation.
5. Selected different user groups.
6. Assigned tasks:
    - Book a token
    - Check queue status
    - Go to profile
    - Return to home
7. Measured:
    - Time taken
    - Errors made
    - User satisfaction

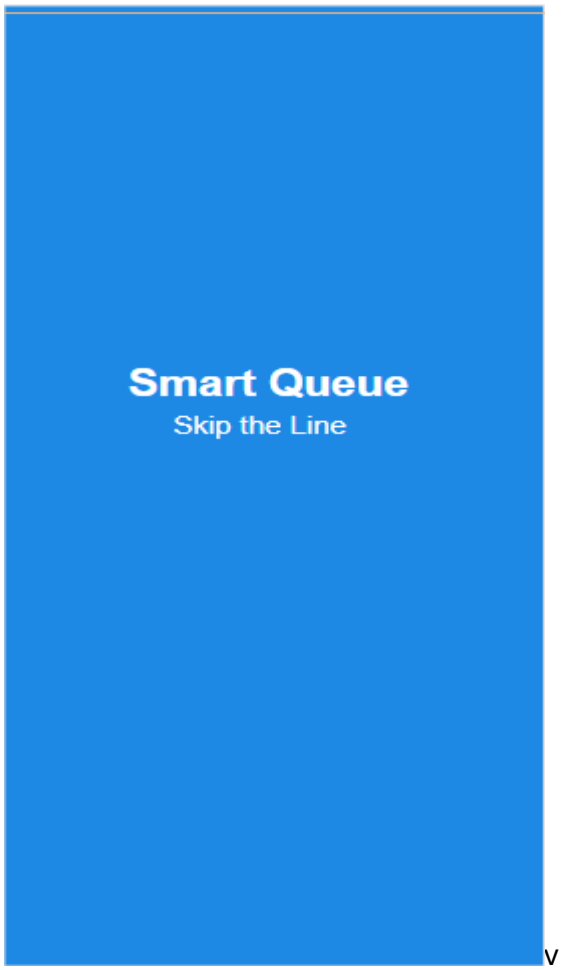
User Groups:

- College students
- Non-technical users
- Elderly users

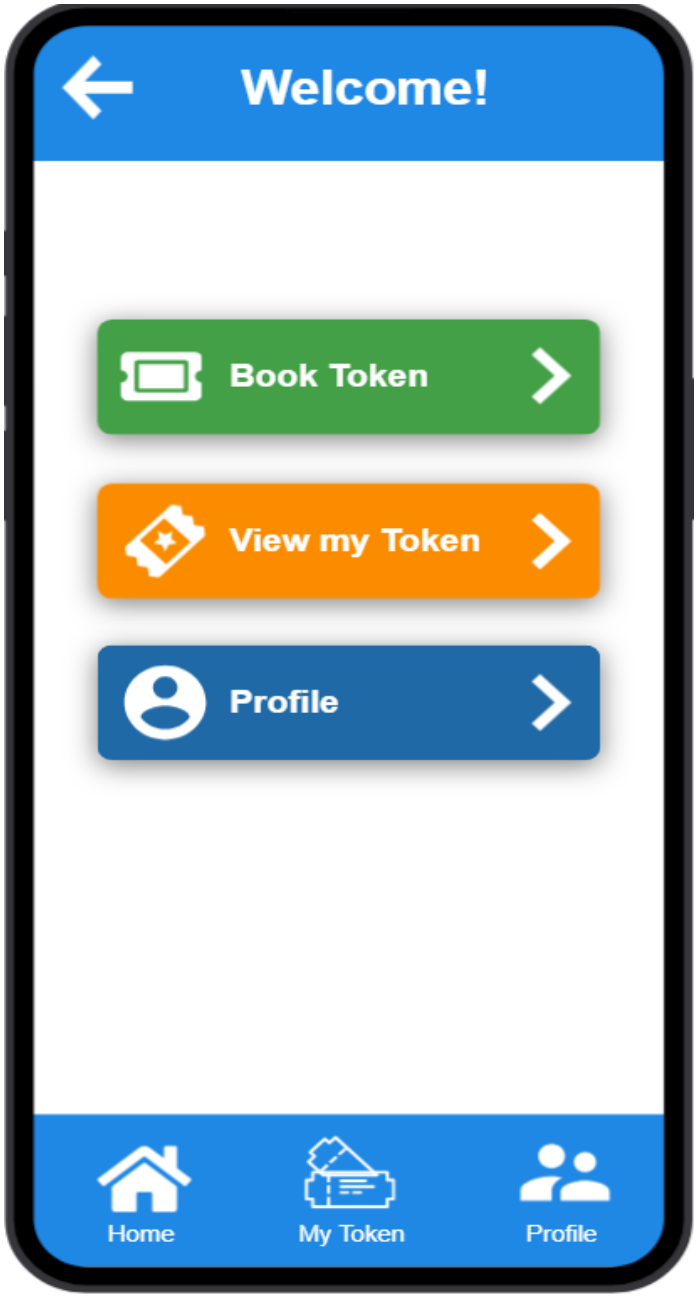
Observation:

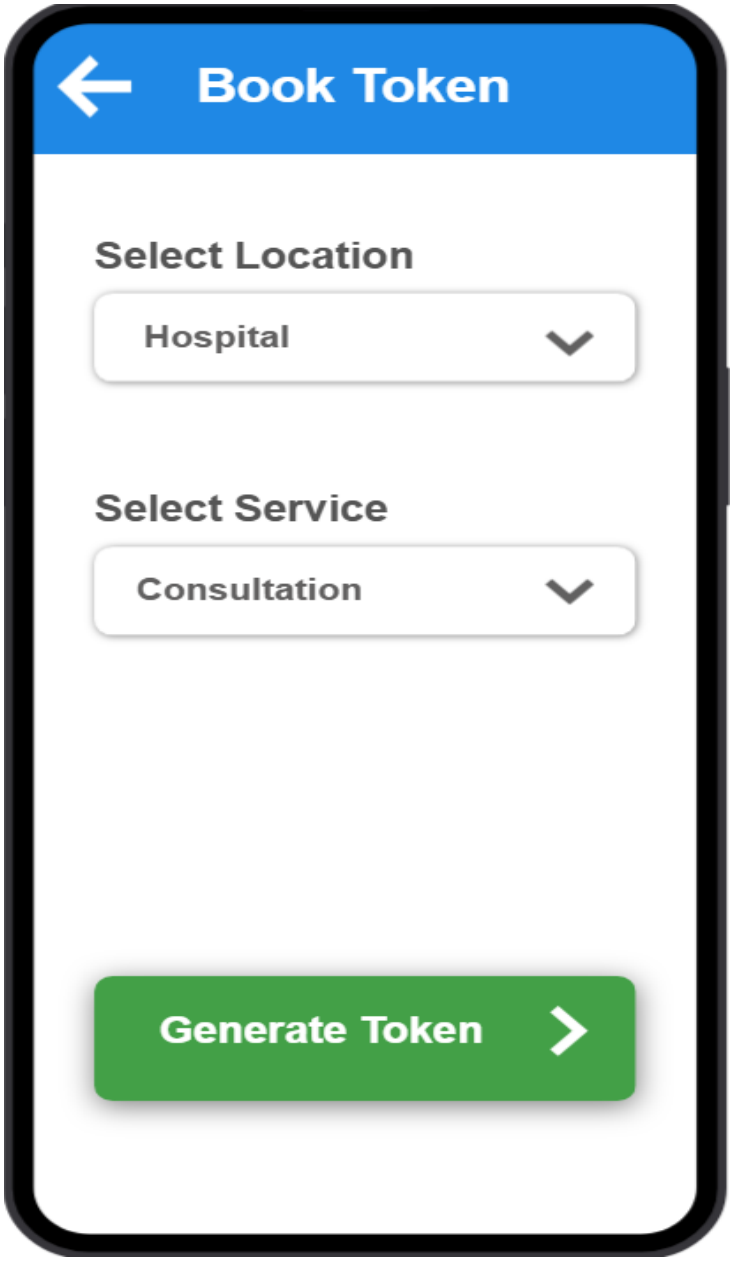
- Users completed tasks faster in the familiar version.
- Fewer errors were observed in familiar navigation.
- Elderly and non-technical users found unfamiliar navigation confusing.
- Hidden gestures increased hesitation.
- Users felt more comfortable and confident with visible navigation elements.

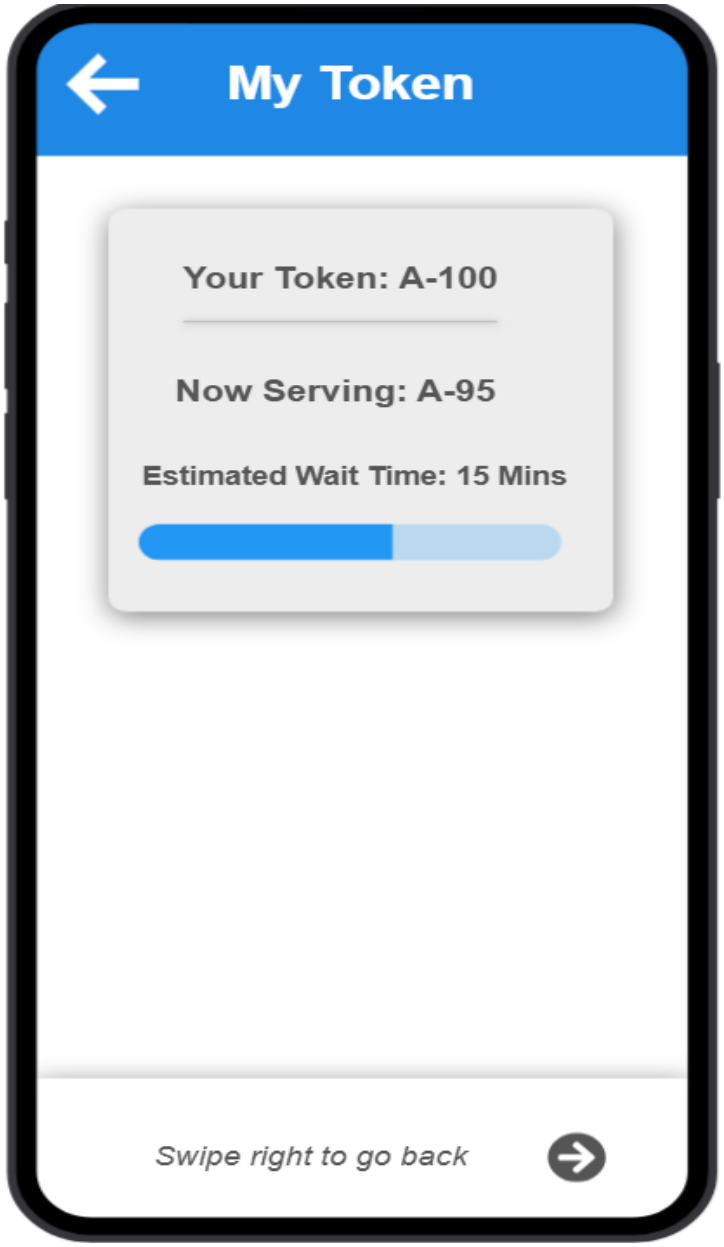
Design Image:

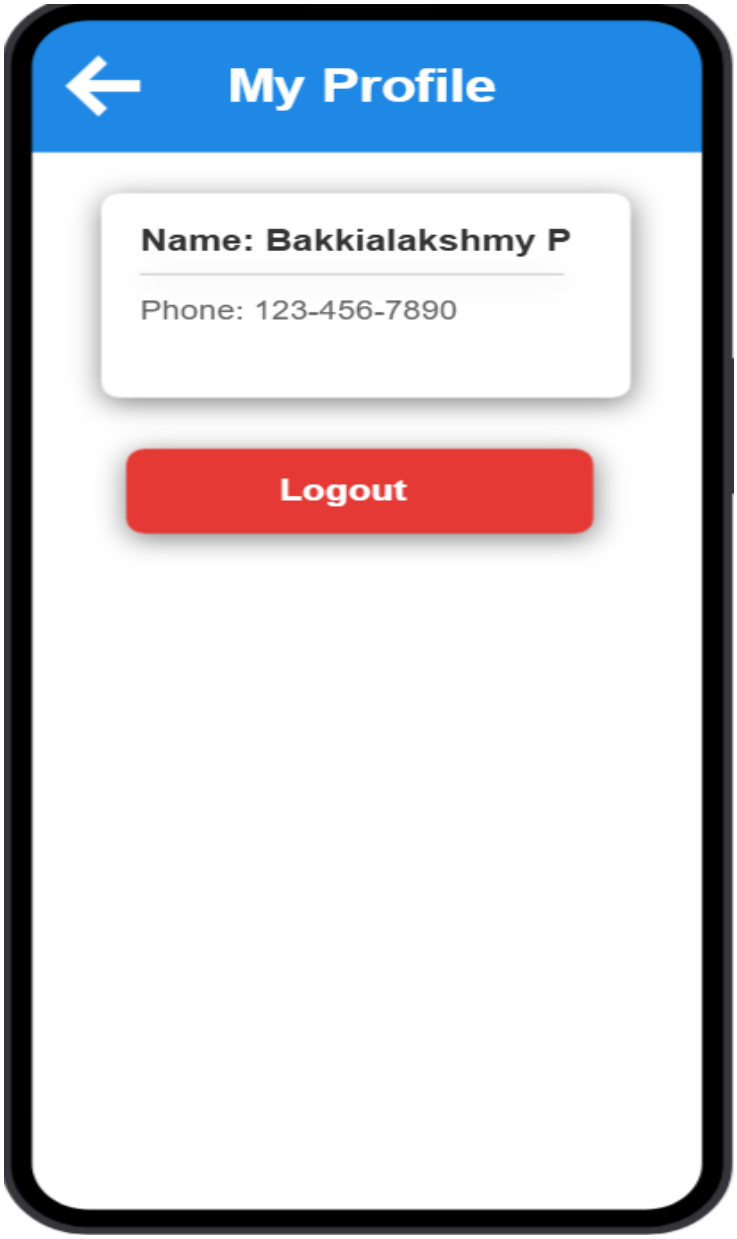


v


Welcome!
Book Token
View my Token
Profile
Home
My Token
Profile


Book Token
Select Location
Hospital
Select Service
Consultation
Generate Token


My Token
Your Token: A-100
Now Serving: A-95
Estimated Wait Time: 15 Mins
Swipe right to go back



Result:

Familiar navigation provided better usability in terms of speed, accuracy, and user satisfaction.